

BM3 — Lesson 3: The Centurion

Faith That Commands Results



Theme: Trusting Jesus' Word



Background Text: Matthew 8:5–13; Luke 7:1–10



Key Verse: Matthew 8:10 (WEB)

“When Jesus heard it, he marveled, and said... ‘Most certainly I tell you, I haven’t found so great a faith, not even in Israel.’”



Faith that trusts the Word, not the circumstances.



Appetizer – The Power of a Word, Matthew 8:5–8 (WEB)

⁵When he came into Capernaum, a centurion came to him, asking him for help,
⁶saying, “Lord, my servant lies in the house paralyzed, grievously tormented.” ⁷Jesus
said to him, “I will come and heal him.”

The centurion answered, ‘Lord, I’m not worthy for you to come under my roof. Just
say the word, and my servant will be healed.’

The centurion didn’t ask Jesus for a visit—he asked Him for a word. He believed that one word from
Jesus could travel farther and work faster than any doctor, medicine, or ritual.



CST Thought

Faith is not about proximity—it’s about posture. The centurion knew Jesus didn’t have to be physically
present to be powerfully effective. True belief doesn’t demand evidence; it simply trusts the Word.

Reflection Question

Have you ever believed God for something without needing to “see” how He would do it?

Main Course

Bite 1 – Humility Before Honor, Luke 7:1–4, 6–7 (WEB)

⁷ After he had finished speaking in the hearing of the people, he entered into Capernaum. ² A certain centurion’s servant, who was dear to him, was sick and at the point of death. ³ When he heard about Jesus, he sent to him elders of the Jews, asking him to come and save his servant. ⁴ When they came to Jesus, they begged him earnestly, saying, “He is worthy for you to do this for him, synagogue for us.”

Jesus went with them. When he was now not far from the house, the centurion sent friends to him, saying to him, ‘Lord, don’t trouble yourself, for I am not worthy for you to come under my roof. Therefore I didn’t even think myself worthy to come to you; but say the word, and my servant will be healed.’”

The Jewish elders said, “He is worthy.” The centurion said, “I am not.” The people pointed to his résumé; he pointed to Jesus’ authority. God in the flesh, (Jesus) was moved by his heart and his application of faith.

CST Thought

Humility is the bridge to divine help. The centurion had status, money, and influence—but he laid all of that down at Jesus’ feet. Faith is strongest when pride is silent.

Reflection Question

How does humility open the door for faith to operate in your life?

Bite 2 – The Understanding of Authority, Matthew 8:9 (WEB)

“For I am also a man under authority, having soldiers under me. I tell this one, ‘Go,’ and he goes; and another, ‘Come,’ and he comes; and to my servant, ‘Do this,’ and he does it.”

The centurion lived his life in chains of command—he understood how orders flowed from a higher rank to those beneath. When he looked at Jesus, he recognized heavenly authority at work: the same power that governs sickness, distance, and timing.

CST Thought

The centurion understood authority not just as control, but as covering. He believed that if Jesus spoke, creation itself had to respond. He saw that Jesus carried a higher command than Rome—kingdom authority.

Reflection Question

When you pray, do you believe the words you speak *in Jesus’ name* carry that same delegated authority?

Bite 3 – Faith That Amazed Jesus, Luke 7:9–10; Matthew 8:13 (WEB)

“When Jesus heard these things, he marveled at him, and turned and said to the multitude who followed him, ‘I tell you, I have not found such great faith, no, not in Israel!’ Those who were sent, returning to the house, found that the servant who had been sick was well.”

“Jesus said to the centurion, ‘Go your way. As you have believed, so let it be done for you.’ His servant was healed in that hour.”

A Roman soldier’s faith made Jesus marvel. No ritual, no long speech, no physical touch—just a request based on understanding who Jesus is and what His Word can do.

CST Thought

Faith works across every barrier—distance, language, culture, status, or time. The Word still heals, restores, and delivers when we believe it and speak it. Let us begin to lean in, unlocking and release the depth and the height of God’s love expressed towards us, the bible says that he doesn’t want his people to be lost but to come to the knowledge of the truth. (2 Peter 3:9)

Reflection Question

Where in your life do you need to trust that God's Word is already at work, even when you can't see the process?

Dessert – Believing Without Seeing

The centurion never demanded, “Show me how.” He simply said, “Just say the word.” His servant was healed without Jesus ever stepping into the house.

Reflection

What would shift in your prayer life if you trusted what God said more than what you see?

To-Go Box

- Faith and foresight together teach us that authority in prayer isn't about volume or visibility—it's about confidence in the Word of God.
- Humility positions us to receive what pride would block.
- Real faith does not require God to “prove it” first; it rests in what He has already spoken.
- When you recognize Jesus' authority, you can walk in your own God-given authority with boldness and peace.

Closing Prayer

“Lord Jesus, thank You for the centurion's example of simple, strong faith. Help me to trust Your Word more than what I see and to pray with confidence in Your authority, not my own strength. Teach me to stay humble, to believe that when You speak, things change. In Your name, amen.”

Personal Prayer Space

Write your own reflection or prayer to God about trusting His Word and His authority in your life:

Word Study

- **Centurion (Latin: *Centurio*)** – A Roman officer over about one hundred soldiers; represents leadership through discipline, obedience, and order.
- **Authority (Greek: *Exousia*, ἐξουσία)** – Permission and delegated power; the right to act. Jesus carries authority over nature, sickness, sin, and even death.
- **Faith (Greek: *Pistis*, πίστις)** – Trust, conviction, and complete reliance upon God’s truth and character.

Write a short line about where you need to trust Jesus’ authority more fully:

Activity – Fill in the Blank

1. The centurion’s faith worked even at a _____.
2. Jesus said, “I have not found anyone in Israel with such great _____.”
3. True faith doesn’t need evidence; it trusts the _____.
4. The centurion understood the power of _____.

(Check the Appendix for answers)

